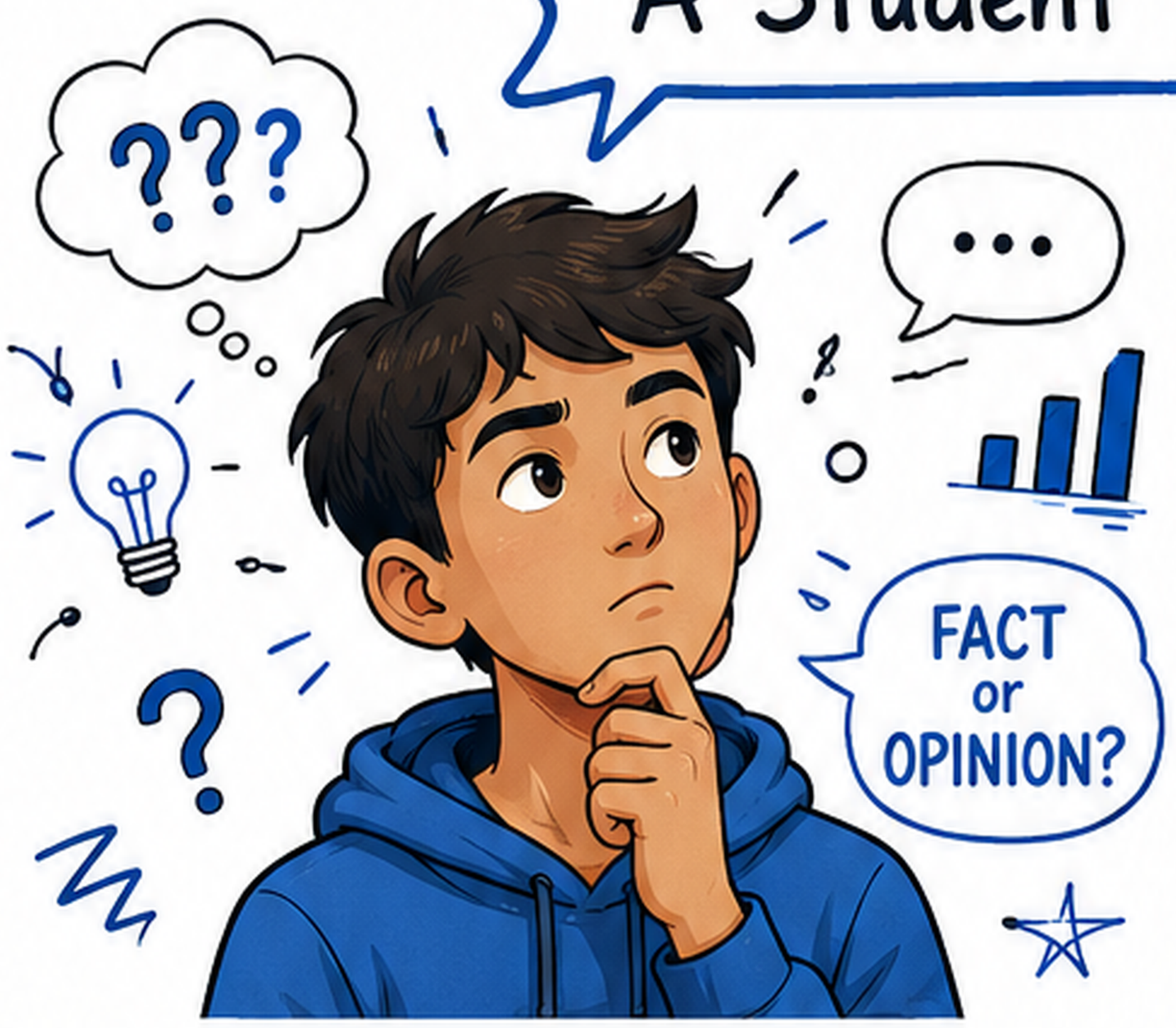
NAME THE CLAIM

A Student Thinking Habit





Before you react, agree, disagree, or decide, figure out what is actually being said.

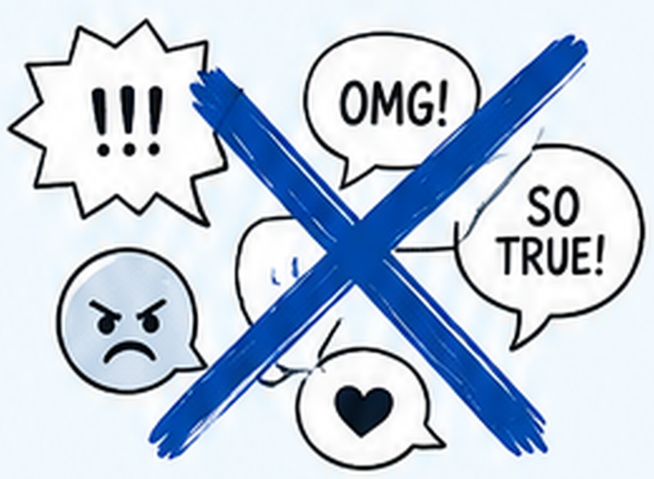
Clear thinking starts with naming the claim.

1 Spot the Main Point



What is the speaker, writer, post, or graph really saying?

2 Ignore the Noise



Extra details, emotions, or drama can hide the real claim.

3 Say It Simply



Restate the claim in one clear sentence.

4 Be Precise



Watch for words like “always,” “never,” “best,” “proves,” or “causes.”

If you can name the claim, you can think about it clearly.

Good thinkers identify the target before they respond.